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Question

The following text is from John Dryden's 1697 translation of Virgil's poem the *Aeneid*, written in the first century BCE. Queen Dido has just heard the Trojan hero Aeneas recount a sad tale.

But anxious cares already seiz'd the queen:

She fed within her veins a flame unseen;

The hero's valor, acts, and birth inspire

Her soul with love, and fan the secret fire.

His words, his looks, imprinted in her heart,

Improve the passion, and increase the smart.

Which choice best states the main purpose of the text?

Answer

- A. To indicate that Dido is hiding her skepticism of Aeneas's account
- B. To emphasize that Dido has been deeply affected by Aeneas's story
- C. To imply that Dido engages both emotionally and intellectually with Aeneas
- D. To suggest that Dido is worried that Aeneas might discover a secret she is keeping from him